



Building an AI Evaluation Checklist

Workshop presented by Sarah Warfield

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August 15, 2026

Beijing American Center

U.S. Embassy Beijing, China



Outline

- Icebreaker 
- Background
- Activity 1: Starting your checklist
- Activity 2: Analyzing AI materials
- Activity 3: Refining your checklist
- Discussion throughout 



By the end of the workshops, you will....



Walk away with a new tool for evaluating AI-generated materials



Think critically about AI-generated language learning tasks



Learn from your colleagues' experience with AI in the classroom



Be excited to use what you've built in your own teaching



You are welcome to take photos during today's presentation.

I will also share the slides and materials at the end.



You are welcome to re-use and share these slides and activities at your school.



Icebreaker: Didn't Live Up to the Hype

#17 Ordered A Beautiful Chrome Doberman Statue, Description Said 3ft Tall











In Groups

- Say “hello” to everyone in your group.
- Choose one person to be the moderator.
 - You will keep the group on task.



In Groups

05:00

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- Think of a time you bought something online and what arrived was nothing like what you expected.
- Use these starters: *"I ordered... but what I got was..."* or *"I thought it would be... but actually..."*
- Everyone shares one story with the group.
- **Moderator**, be sure everyone shares something.
- *No shopping stories?* Think of a time something was not as good as you expected.



All of these “shopping fails” are examples of a lack of **quality control**.

This is why we need **humans in the loop**.





Background



AI Use in Language Education



GROWING USE

AI tools are increasingly common in language education, with research documenting their use for lesson planning, materials development, assessment, feedback, and classroom support (Huang et al., 2023; Jiang, 2022; Zhou & Hou, 2025).



PREPARING TEACHING MATERIALS

62.5%

of EFL teachers in a study of 24 university teachers in China reported using AI to prepare teaching materials — updating courseware, generating syllabi, and creating discussion questions.

(Zhou & Hou, 2025)



UNESCO AI Competency Framework for Teachers

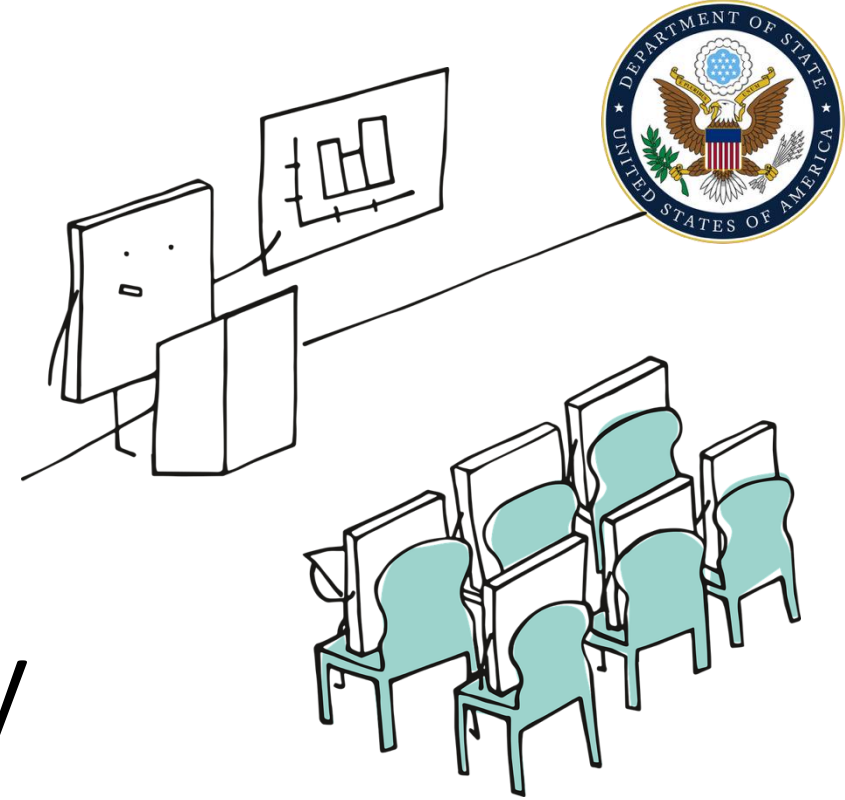




Table 1. The AI competency framework high-level structure: aspects and progression levels

Aspects	Progression		
	Acquire	Deepen	Advance
1. Human-centred mindset	Human-centred thinking	Human accountability	Social responsibility
2. Ethics of AI	Ethical principles	Safe and responsible use	Co-creating ethical rules
3. AI foundations and applications	Basic AI techniques and applications	Application skills	Creating with AI
4. AI pedagogy	AI-assisted teaching	AI–pedagogy integration	AI-enhanced pedagogical transformation
5. AI for professional development	AI enabling lifelong professional learning	AI to enhance organizational learning	AI to support professional transformation



When teachers skip application skills, they lose the ability to:

- Judge whether AI-generated content is accurate or appropriate
- Spot limitations or bias in what AI produces
- Make informed decisions about what to keep, adapt, or discard



A profession in transition

Fluency is decoupling from competence.

AI-polished writing was rated significantly better written, with no gain in conceptual understanding (Tärning et al., 2025).

Learners feel it too. Students describe “generation-and-approval” as requiring a fraction of the skill of “reading-writing-revision” (Yan, 2023).

Even evaluation is becoming illegible. Students often couldn't tell if a human or AI scored their work, and that uncertainty changed how fair they judged it to be (Thomas et al., 2025).

FUNDAMENTALS OF English Grammar

FIFTH EDITION
WORKBOOK

Betty S. Azar
Stacy A. Hagen
Geneva Tesh



We mark it up, change it, and
adapt it for our students.

Chapter 8 Verb Tenses

8.1 Simple Present and Present Continuous

A. Complete the sentences. Use the correct form of the verb in parentheses.

1. I usually go (go) to class by bus.
2. Right now, she is studying (study) for her test.
3. They play (play) soccer every Saturday ?
4. Look! The dog is running (run) in the park.

B. Complete the chart.

	Simple Present	Present Continuous
I / You / We / They	<u>study</u>	<u>am/is/are studying</u>
He / She / It	<u>studies</u>	<u>is studying</u>

Common Time Expressions

Simple Present: always, usually, often, never, every day, on Mondays

Present Continuous: now, right now, at the moment, look, listen

C. Write sentences using the cues.

1. (she / not / like / coffee)
She doesn't like coffee.
2. (we / watch / a movie / tonight)
We are watching a movie tonight.
3. (he / usually / get up / early)
He usually gets up early.

Extension Activity

Interview a classmate about their daily routine.
Ask 5 questions using the present simple.

Good
example!

Student-friendly
explanation
Use Simple
Present for
routines and
facts.

Real-life connection

How do you
spend your
Saturdays?

Check for understanding

- ☒ I get it
☐ I need
more help

Differentiation

Challenge:
Write 3 sentences
about your week.

Support:
Use the word bank
on p. 150.

Exit Ticket

Write one thing you
do every day and
one thing you are
doing right now.



Highlight



Text



Note



Link



Image



Checklist

Magic School AI: Program brings efficiency, individualization to Horry Co. Schools

by Connor Ingalls | Mon, August 18, 2025 at 3:48 PM

Bentonville Schools officials say AI tool will 'give teachers back some time,' guide students through some assignments

January 23, 2026 by Edward McKinnon

EDUCATION

Denver Public Schools implements AI in the classroom

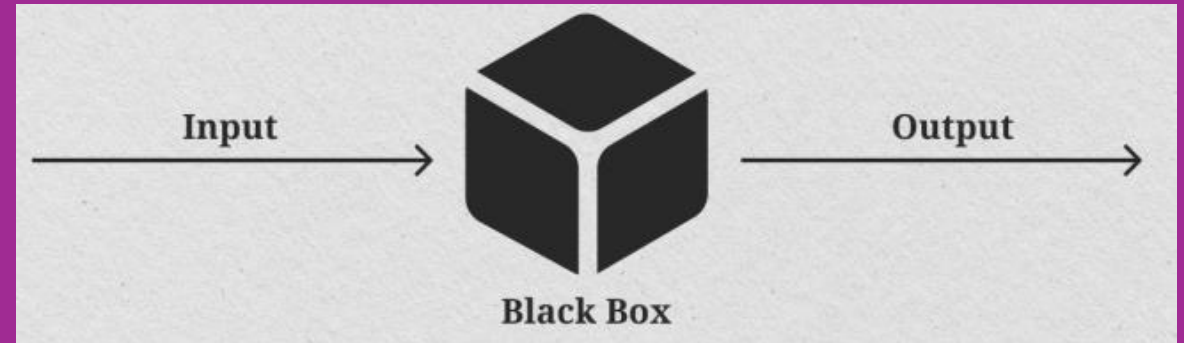
Approved tools include Gemini, NotebookLM and MagicSchool for student use.



Academics Admissions & Aid Student Life Athletics & Recreation Careers & Outcomes About

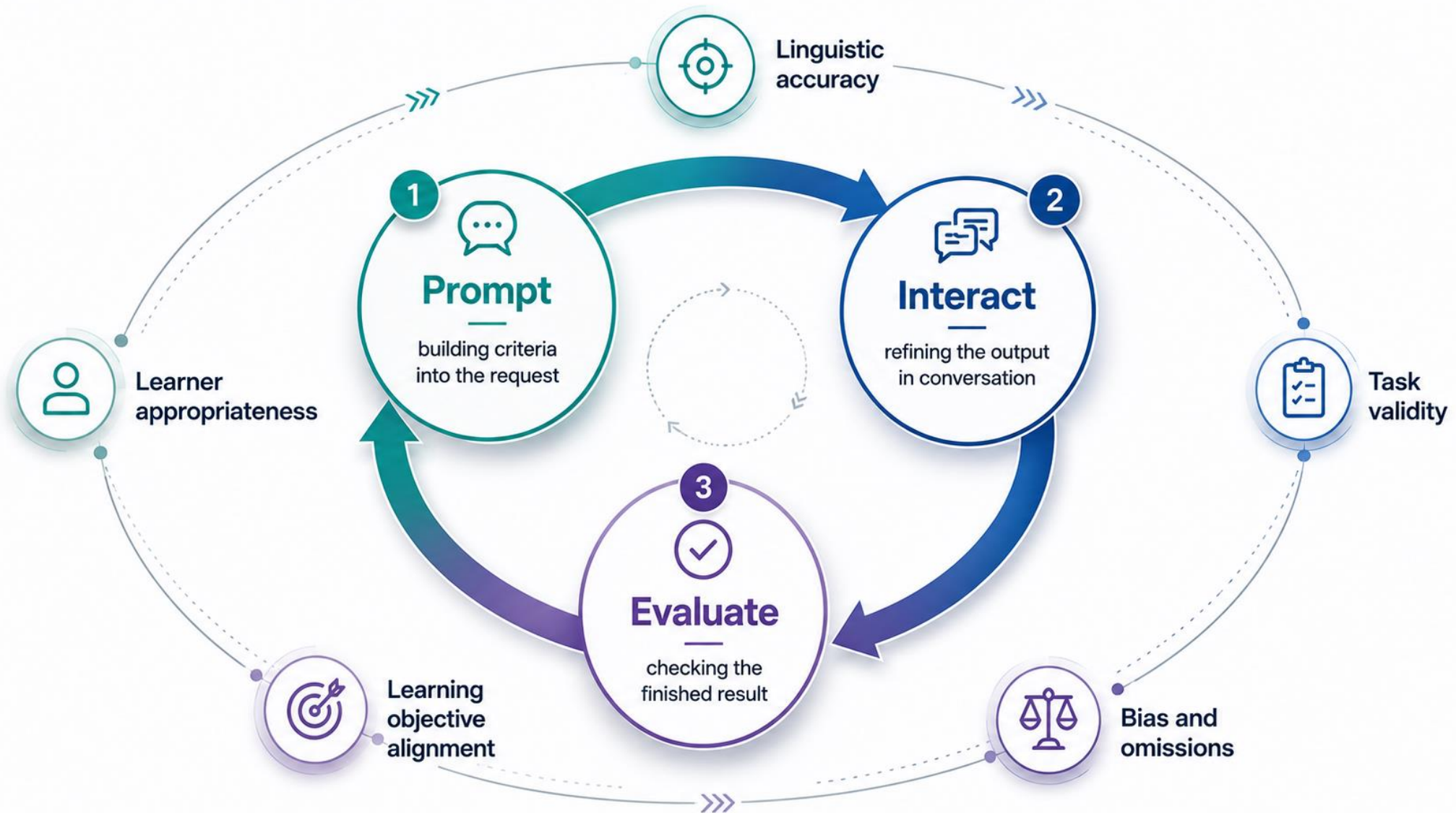
Gisele El Khoury Highlights AI-Powered Feedback on Student Writing with Brisk Teaching

Apr 5, 2026



The black box isn't fixed.
How much of it you can see
and shape depends on the
platform you choose and how
you choose to use it.

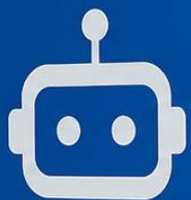
A Framework for Evaluating AI-Generated Materials





How you interact with AI matters

AI TOOLS AREN'T VENDING MACHINES



They require
judgment, context,
and human expertise.



THINK



EVALUATE



ADAPT

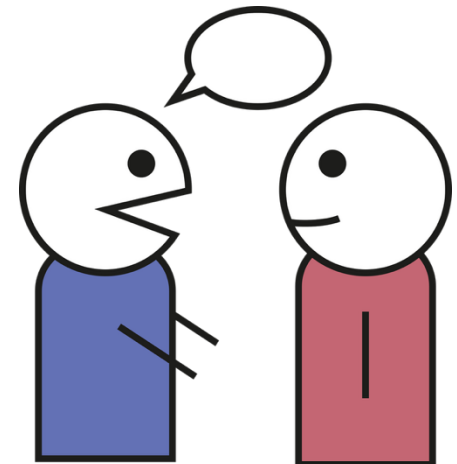


What do you think?

02:00

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- Turn to your neighbor
- Say *Hello!*
- How do you feel about using AI to generate language learning materials?
- *What do you think?*





Activity 1: Starting your checklist



Prompting for AI materials



Proficiency level(s) of your learners



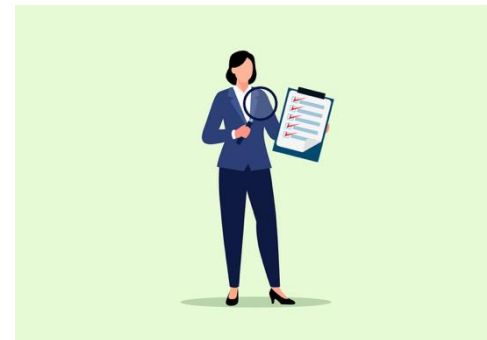
Classroom context



Type of task



Four strands of language learning





Four Strands of Language Learning (Paul Nation)



Meaning-focused input

Reading and listening to comprehensible content slightly above students' current level. Focus is on understanding meaning, not on language forms.

Sample task: Read an article and answer comprehension questions.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the text level appropriate? Does the task keep focus on meaning rather than form?



Meaning-focused output

Speaking and writing for communicative purposes. Students focus on conveying meaning rather than accuracy.

Sample task: Write an email to a friend describing a recent experience.

When evaluating AI materials:

Does the task give students a real communicative purpose? Or does it feel like a grammar exercise in disguise?



Language-focused learning

Deliberate attention to vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation. Includes explicit instruction and practice.

Sample task: Identify and correct errors in a paragraph.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the language focus clear and appropriate for the level? Are the examples accurate?



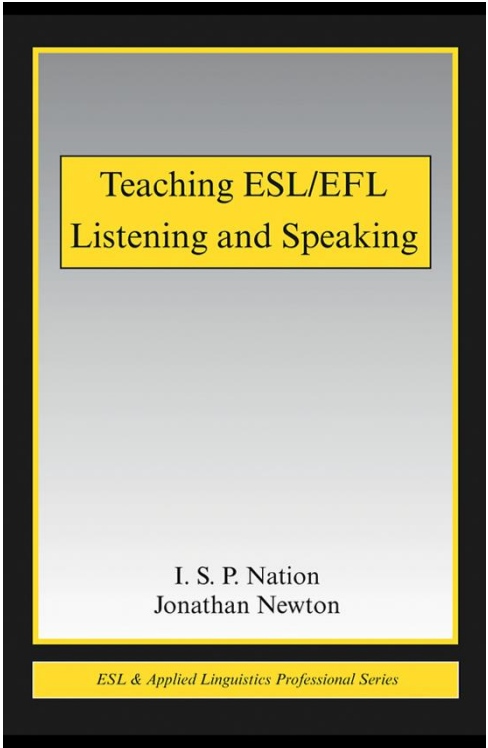
Fluency development

Repeated practice with familiar language to build speed and automaticity. Content should be easy so students can focus on performance.

Sample task: Retell a familiar story in two minutes.

When evaluating AI materials:

Is the content genuinely easy enough to allow fluency practice, or is it actually a new learning task?



About 25% of class time for each strand. Language-focused learning should not be more than 25%.



TWO PROMPTS

1



Prompt

building criteria
into the request

PROMPT 1

Create a writing task for B2 EFL students about rhetorical organization.

2



Interact

refining the output
in conversation

PROMPT 2

Create a writing task for B2-level EFL university students. The focus is rhetorical organization — specifically thesis statements and paragraph structure. Students have already practiced topic sentences and supporting evidence but struggle with writing clear, arguable thesis statements. This task will feed into a final assessed essay at the end of the unit. This is an afternoon class, so the task should be engaging and include a brief collaborative warm-up before individual writing. Students have 45 minutes.



Interacting with the first output

PROMPT 3



PROMPT 3

This should function as meaning-focused output — students writing for a real communicative purpose — not a disguised grammar or structure drill. Keep any explicit instruction on thesis/paragraph form brief, and let most of the task time go toward students actually writing and revising real content.

02:00

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What do you think?

- Turn to your neighbor
- Say *Hello!*
- What would you add to your prompt to make it fit your classroom/pedagogy?
- *What do you think?*



Proficiency level(s) of your learners



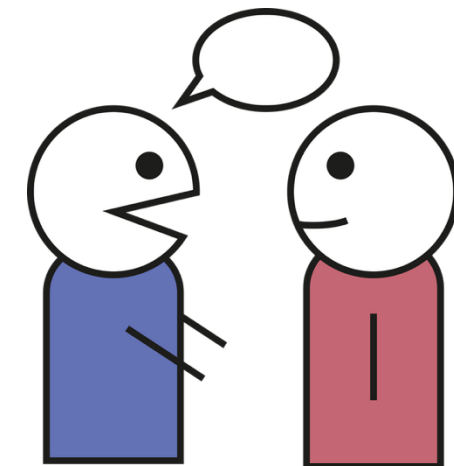
Classroom context



Type of task



Four strands of language learning

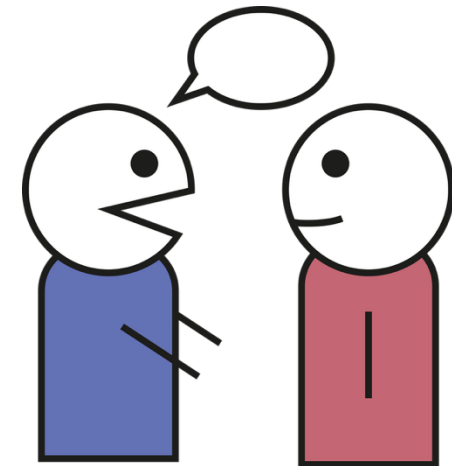


02:00

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What do you think?

- Turn to your neighbor
- *Say Hello!*
- How will you check the quality of your AI-generated materials?
- *What do you think?*

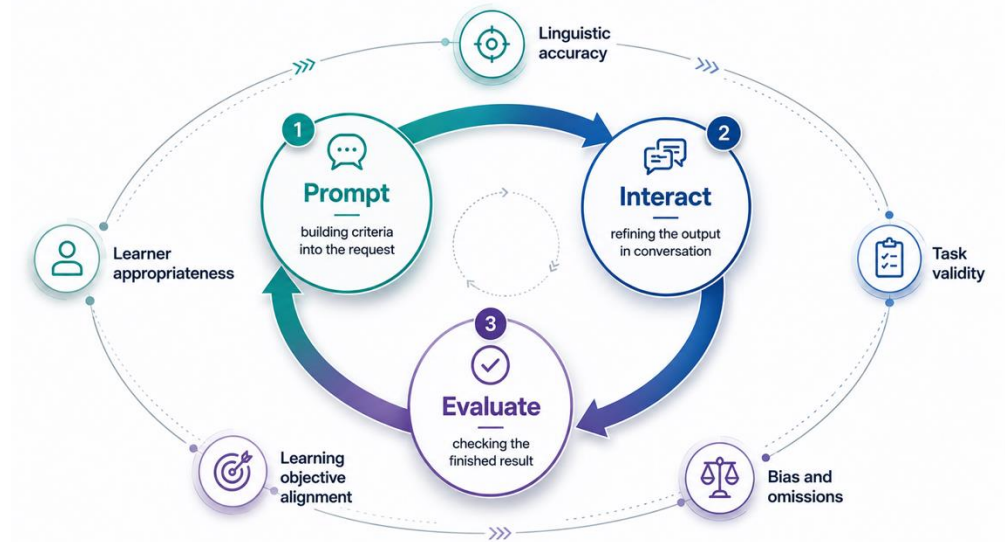


05:00

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In Pairs

- Work with one other group member
- Choose one person to be the *recorder*
- Brainstorm a list of questions you can use to review AI-created materials
- Try to write five



02:00

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In Groups

- Share your lists with the group.
- ***Moderator***, make sure everyone contributes
- Explain your questions and rationale to one another.

02:00

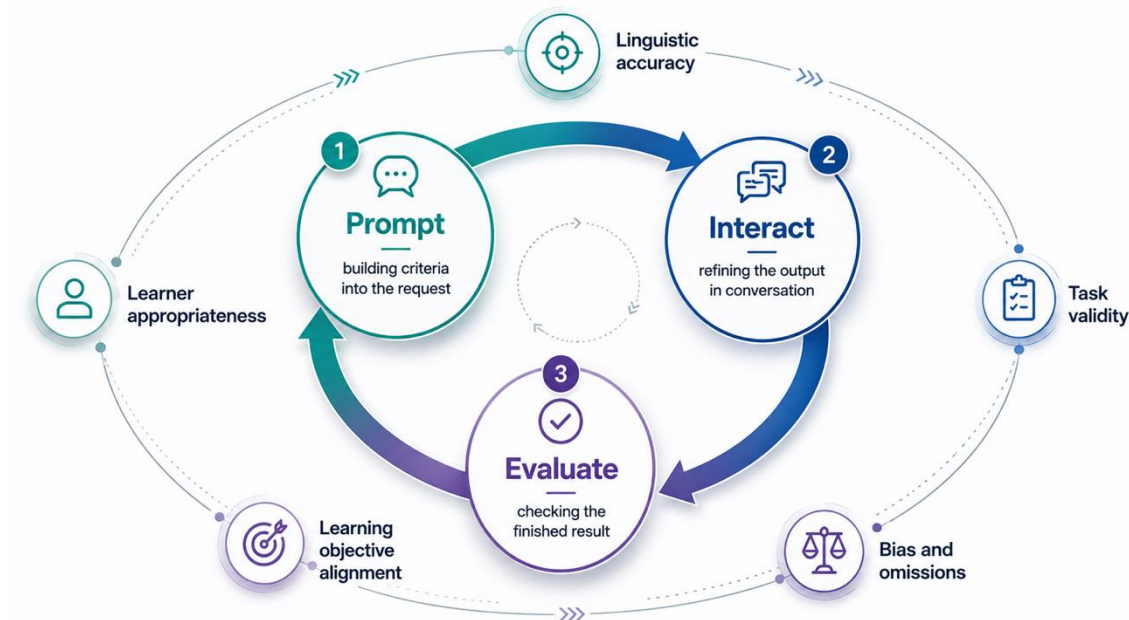
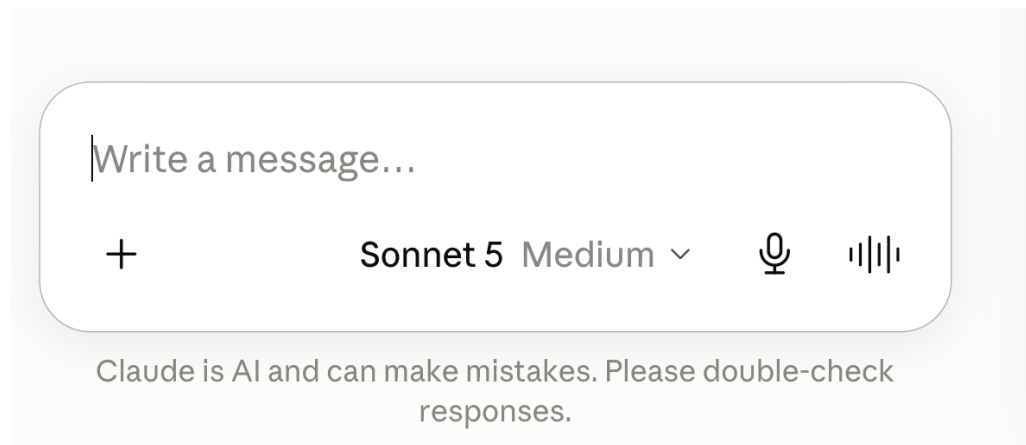
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In Pairs

- Look at your list again
- Agree on your five final questions
- Write them at the top of your poster



Collaboration and AI



Have you added a collaborative component to your generation of AI materials?



Rationale

- Research on teacher collaboration shows benefits for teachers, students, and schools, particularly when collaboration involves substantive professional learning rather than simply working alongside one another (Vangrieken et al., 2015).
- Collaborative work gives teachers opportunities to examine practice together, share expertise, and improve instruction (Weddle, 2022).
- Teacher collaboration can influence teachers' day-to-day classroom practices and contribute to professional development and student learning (Weddle, 2022).
- Evaluating AI-generated materials should not have to be an individual task.



In Sum

- Keeping humans in the loop will ensure your AI-generated materials are appropriate for your teaching context
- Be wary of the “black box” approach to language learning
- AI materials generation goes beyond the prompt, it also includes analyzing the output



Let's take a break!



Activity 2: Analyzing AI materials



Outline

- Using AI to generate lesson plans
- In Pairs: Analyzing AI-Generated Lesson Plans
- In Groups: Sharing out results
- Gallery Walk
- Conclusion



Studies of AI-generated lesson plans have found:

- Questionable components, missing details, and fabricated resources (Powell & Courchesne, 2024)
- Minimal alignment with frameworks designed to support diverse learners (Lammert et al., 2024)
- Limited opportunities for higher-order thinking (Trust et al., 2025)
- AI-generated plans can be formulaic, even across different learning objectives (Trust et al., 2025)

Teacher evaluation and modification remain essential.

REMEMBER WHAT AN LLM IS

A large language model is a prediction system.



HOW IT WORKS

- Your input is broken into **tokens**
- The model predicts a probability distribution for the **next token**
- It selects a token and **repeats** the process
- Transformers allow those predictions to incorporate large amounts of **context**
- Training, scale, and fine-tuning make the resulting language remarkably **fluent**
- But fluency is **not** evidence of understanding, truth, or pedagogical judgment



HUMAN-LIKE ≠ HUMAN



Conversational interfaces encourage us to attribute human qualities to AI.



Human-like language and other social cues can increase perceived human-likeness and trust.



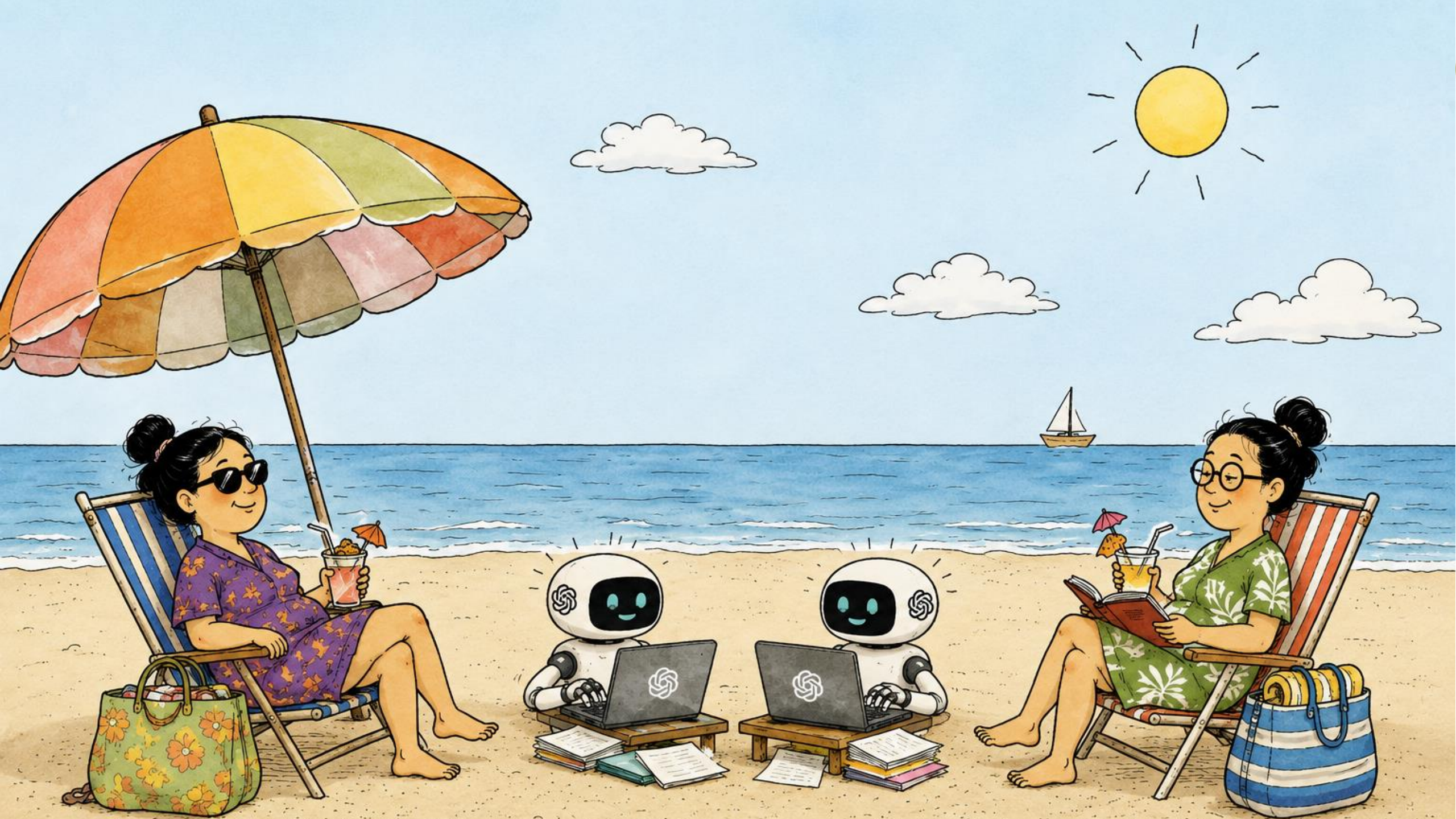
The appearance of thought or agency should not be confused with evidence of human cognition.

Fluent ≠ Factual

Confident ≠ Certain

Human-like language ≠ Human thought

(Cohn et al., 2024; Klein, 2025)

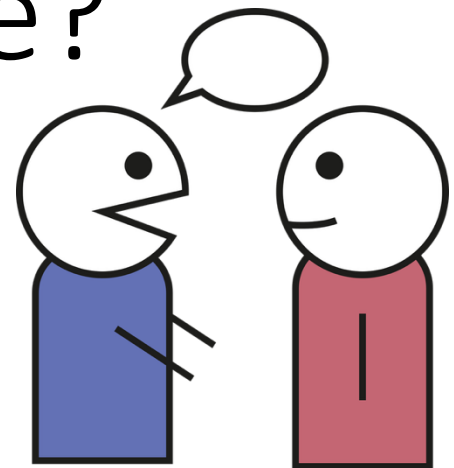


What do you think?

02:00

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- Turn to your neighbor
- Say *Hello!*
- Does using AI give you more time? If so, how do you use the extra time?
- *What do you think?*





Two Lesson Plans

Lesson Plan 1 (Deepseek)



Prompt: Give me a 50-minute lesson plan on thesis statements

Lesson Plan 2 (Deepseek)



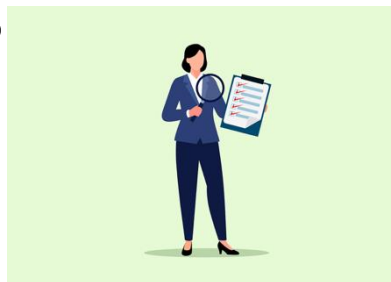
Prompt: Create a writing task for B2-level EFL university students. The focus is rhetorical organization — specifically thesis statements and paragraph structure. Students have already practiced topic sentences and supporting evidence but struggle with writing clear, arguable thesis statements. This task will feed into a final assessed essay at the end of the unit. This is an afternoon class, so the task should be engaging and include a brief collaborative warm-up before individual writing. Students have 45 minutes.

In Pairs

05:00

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- Using your five questions as criteria, evaluate the AI-generated materials at your table and record your findings on your poster.



Question 1	
Question 2	
Question 3	
Question 4	
Question 5	

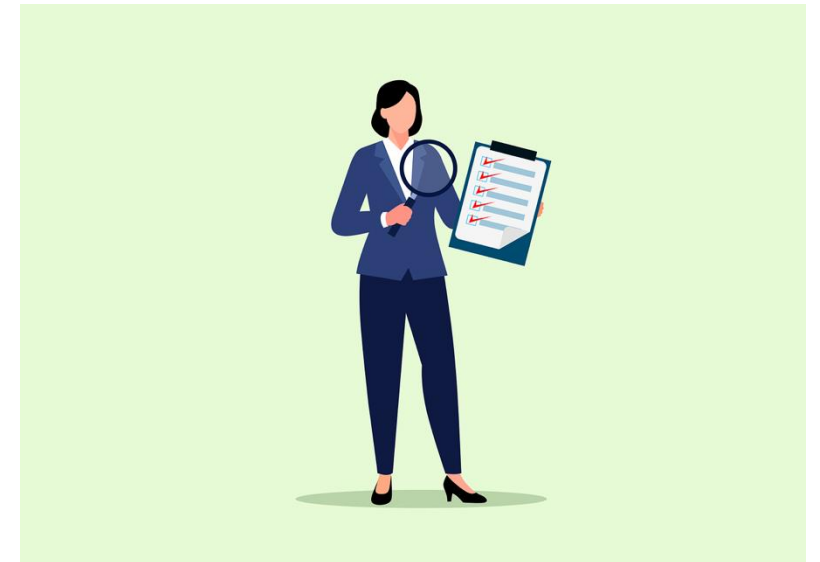
Task One :	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

Task Two:	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

05:00

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- Share your posters with the group.
- ***Moderator***, make sure everyone contributes



Gallery Walk

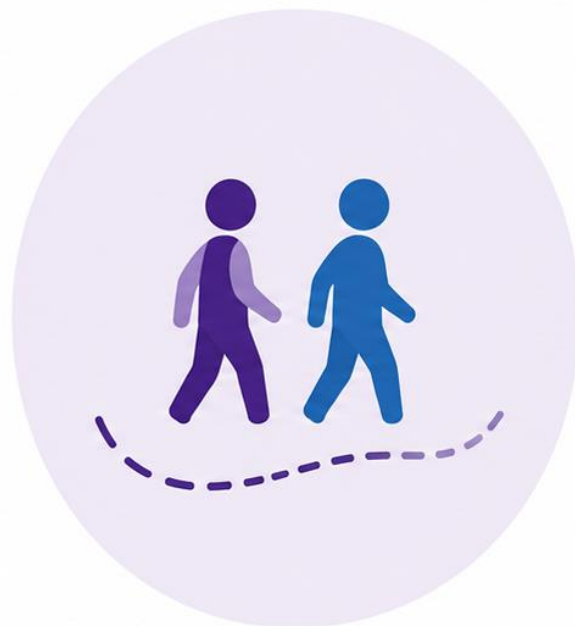


- Has anyone used a gallery walk in their classroom before?
- Effective for large classrooms
 - Students can see each others' work
- Effective for formative assessments
 - Easy to check on student progress in a low-stakes way
- Great for learning!
 - Movement and blood flow support cognition

02:00

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Gallery Walk



Travel
in pairs



Choose one
recorder



Spend two
minutes at
each poster



Use the stickers
to leave comments
on the work of
your peers



Activity 3:

Refining your checklist





AI & Quality Control



AI learns what a lesson plan looks like, not what language learning is



It can **reproduce the structure** of a good lesson



It **does not understand** why balance across strands matters



It **does not know** that fluency comes from meaningful, repeated use



It **does not know** that form-focused tasks work best when connected to real communication



Pair Work

05:00

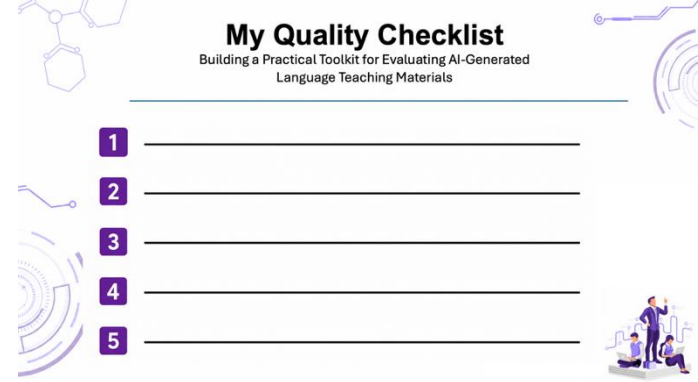
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Work with your partner to discuss the comments from the gallery walk.

Which comment surprised you most?

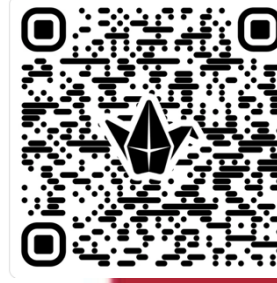
Is there a question on your list that didn't work as well as you thought?

What's one thing you want to add or change based on the feedback?



Individual Work

1. Fill in **My Quality Checklist**
2. Upload a picture to our Padlet
Checklist + selfie (optional)
3. Leave comments on other teachers' Final Checklist Certificates
4. Try your checklist using the prompt on Padlet



Write your name here

Add section

Sarah Warfield
6 minutes ago

Selfie...optional



Add comment

Sarah Warfield
6 minutes ago

New post here with a picture of your
checklist



Add comment

Sarah Warfield
3 minutes ago

Try this prompt with your checklist



Create a writing task for B2-level EFL university students. The focus is rhetorical organization — specifically thesis statements and paragraph structure. Students have already practiced topic sentences and supporting evidence but struggle with writing clear, arguable thesis statements. This task will feed into a final assessed essay at the end of the unit. This is an afternoon class, so the task should be engaging and include a brief collaborative warm-up before individual writing. Students have 45 minutes.

Share your results.

Add comment

Applying Your Checklist



1

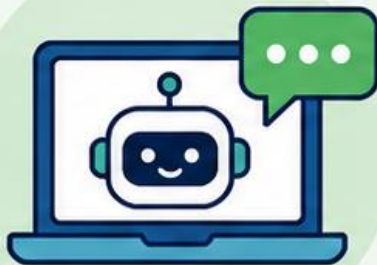


Use the checklist in your initial prompt

Add your checklist criteria to your prompt when creating materials.



2



Interact with the AI tool using the checklist

Use the checklist to guide your conversation and refine the output before the final output.



3

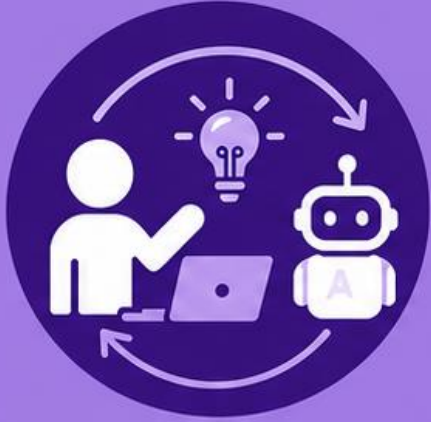


Evaluate the final output against your checklist

Review the final materials using your checklist to ensure quality, accuracy, and alignment.



In Conclusion



GenAI is a powerful new digital tool in our teaching toolkit—but we must keep humans in the loop.



As AI in education becomes more normalized, we can act as guides and decision makers on how AI is applied in our own classrooms.



We should engage more with the **process** of AI rather than the **product** to ensure best outcomes for ourselves and the students we teach.



By the end of the workshop, you will....



Walk away with a new tool for evaluating AI-generated materials



Think critically about AI-generated language learning tasks



Learn from your colleagues' experience with AI in the classroom



Be excited to use what you've built in your own teaching



Thank you!

Let's eat lunch!



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